Kiro offers two distinct ways to build software, each suited for different situations and goals:

🎨 Vibe Coding: The "Just Build It" Approach

What is Vibe Coding?

Vibe coding is like walking into a restaurant and saying "surprise me with something delicious." You give Kiro a high-level idea of what you want, and it figures out all the details and builds it for you.

How it Works:

1. You describe your idea in plain English
2. Kiro immediately starts building
3. Kiro makes decisions about technology, design, and implementation
4. You provide feedbacks and adjustments as Kiro works
5. You get a working product quickly

Real-World Example:

You may write

```
Build me a chatbot website that can answer customer questions.
```

Then Kiro immediately starts

- creating the website,
- choosing technologies,
- designing the interface,
- setting up servers,
- and deploying everything.

When to Use Vibe Coding:

- You want to test an idea quickly
- You're exploring possibilities
- You trust Kiro to make good technical decisions
- You want to see results fast
- You're building a prototype or proof-of-concept
- You're learning and experimenting

Advantages:

- **Speed**: Get from idea to working product in hours, not weeks
- **Simplicity**: No need to understand technical details
- **Exploration**: Great for discovering what's possible
- **Low commitment**: Easy to start over if you don't like the direction

Limitations:

- Less control over specific technical choices
- May not follow your exact preferences for how things should be built
- Documentation might be minimal
- Harder to make precise modifications later

📋 Spec Coding: The "Blueprint First" Approach

What is Spec Coding?

Spec coding is like working with an architect to design a house. Before any construction begins, you create detailed blueprints, discuss every room, choose materials, and plan every aspect. Only then does the building begin.

How it Works:

1. You work with Kiro to create detailed specifications
2. Together, you plan the architecture and design
3. You review and approve each phase before moving forward
4. Kiro builds according to the agreed specifications
5. You get exactly what was planned, with full documentation

Real-World Example: You may write

```
I want to build a chatbot website.
```

Kiro may reply

```
Let's create a specification first.
What features do you need?
Who will use it?
What should the interface look like?
What security requirements do you have?
```

Together you create a 20-page specification document.

Kiro then replies

```
Now I'll build exactly what we've specified.
```

When to Use Spec Coding:

- You're building something for business use
- You need specific features and functionality
- Multiple people will work on or maintain the project
- You need detailed documentation
- Security and compliance are important
- You want predictable outcomes
- The project is complex or long-term

Advantages:

- **Control**: You decide exactly how everything should work
- **Documentation**: Complete records of what was built and why
- **Predictability**: You know what you'll get before building starts
- **Maintainability**: Easy to modify and extend later
- **Collaboration**: Multiple people can understand and work on the project
- **Quality**: More thorough planning leads to better results

Limitations:

- Takes longer to get started
- Requires more upfront thinking and planning
- May feel overwhelming for simple projects
- Less flexibility for major changes during development

Detailed Comparison

A detailed comparison of the two approaches are available below.

Aspect	Vibe Coding	Spec Coding
Time to Start	Immediate	Several hours of planning
Time to First Result	Minutes to hours	Hours to days
Control Level	Low - Kiro decides	High - You decide everything
Documentation	Minimal	Comprehensive
Best for Beginners	Yes - very approachable	Moderate - requires more thinking
Best for Business	Prototypes only	Production applications
Flexibility	High - easy to change direction	Moderate - changes require spec updates
Learning Curve	Very gentle	Steeper but more educational

Now that you are familiar with the different coding approaches in Kiro. In the next section we will discuss some use-case examples for vibe coding and spec coding that can help you in making the right choice while working on your projects.

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